

announced very impressive numbers about the growth and momentum of mobile devices market and a lot of it was accredited to the Adobe Flash Player and platforms providing support for Adobe AIR applications. To quote a few points, there were at least 20,00,000 Flash Player 10.1 installs in the first six months after its launch, statistically accounting for around 12 per cent of the smartphones shipped last year and the market survey by Strategy Analytics estimates that in 2011 alone more than 132 million smartphones will have Flash Player support, representing at least 36 per cent of all smartphones being sold worldwide.

By the end of last year, developers and content authors across the globe were deploying Adobe AIR applications in over eighty four million mobile devices running Android and iOS. This number is expected to rise dramatically to at least over two hundred million by the end of this year. During the initial two months after the release of AIR on the Android platform, more than 1,500 applications were created and were available for download on the Android Marketplace. Today, it is estimated that at least 3 million Flash Platform developers are employing Adobe Creative Suite 5 tools to create content and build applications across a substantial number of devices which use either the Flash Player or AIR. Adobe also in the meantime is working extra hard to improve its offerings and make cross platform mobile application development even easier, so you expect a lot more developments in the near future.

Because of the increasing demand for building applications for mobile devices a need for a simplified unified methodology has emerged. You'll see that Adobe AIR and its APIs are a big step in this direction. The major difference between AIR apps for mobile and the legacy AIR apps created for desktops is that for mobile app development you can use only ActionScript or Flex currently, unlike for desktop applications where you can make use of HTML, JavaScript, and CSS as well.

There are three main primary categories of applications that you can you build using AIR, ActionScript, and Flex for mobiles devices:

Games

The same old Flash games that we so love playing on the web and on our desktops can now be run inside an AIR app that can be packaged into mobile devices. For example, the Green Hornet Crime Fighter is an old Flash game that has also been converted into an AIR app for mobile. Kongregate also offers several Flash games which have optimised for AIR in a mobile. They even have support for GPU acceleration if required.